

Crash Into Me -- Dave Matthews Band

Bass: Harley Benton P/J, 5-string, passive. Full board.

1996 acoustic-driven ballad (*Crash*). ~70 BPM (estimate -- no hard chart reference, tempo isn't load-bearing for the tone choices below). Stefan Lessard's part here is melodic and understated, not a rhythm-section anchor -- mostly warm, supportive fingerstyle lines with harmonics and higher-register melodic fills, especially into the outro. The song doesn't have a big rock dynamic swing; it stays intimate almost throughout, with only a modest lift into the "you come crash into me" hook. The patch reflects that restraint -- one steady tone, one small swell, nothing more.

Why a NAM here

Darkglass Harmonic Booster (Slot 60), dialed as a genuine clean tone. Per the correction Michael gave (2026-09-08, see `NAMs/nams.md`), this capture is quite clean-voiced -- a harmonic-enhancer boost, not a drive/distortion pedal like the other Darkglass captures. That subtle harmonic richness fits this song's woody, slightly shimmering fingerstyle character better than a flatter clean tone would, without adding any audible grit. Per the current NAM weighting (bass NAMs get strong preference), this beats reaching for a built-in AMP/CAB or one of the bass cab IRs here.

GP-5 Settings

Module order: NR -> PRE -> DST -> AMP -> CAB -> EQ -> MOD -> DLY -> RVB

NR -- Gate

- THRE: 16
- Always on. Very low-gain, clean patch with a lot of quiet/harmonic playing -- kept light so it doesn't choke off soft notes or harmonic decay.

PRE -- COMP (Ross Compressor)

- Sustain: 40, VOL: 55
- Always on. Gentle glue and sustain for a fingerstyle melodic part with real dynamic range (ghost notes, harmonics, fuller lines) -- not squashing anything, just evening it out the way an organic, unforced tone should.

DST -- Off

Not used. No drive anywhere in this tone.

AMP / CAB -- Off (NAM in use)

- **NAM: Darkglass Harmonic Booster, Slot 60.**
- Settings: Gain 30, VOL 65, Bass 58, Middle 55, Treble 52.
- Gain kept low -- this is a clean tone using the capture's harmonic character, not its potential as a boost/drive stage. Bass pushed to 58 for warmth and foundation. Treble held back a touch (52) to keep the tone woody rather than bright/glassy.

- `AMP` and `CAB` both `model: null` -- a NAM always replaces both.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1

- 33Hz: +3, 150Hz: +1, 600Hz: -2, 2kHz: +2, 8kHz: 0, VOL: 52
- Always on, both CTL states. A gentle low-end lift for foundation, a small 600Hz dip to keep things from getting boxy, and a modest 2kHz nudge for note definition under the acoustic guitars -- nothing aggressive, no top-end push. This stays warm and unforced, matching the song's whole character.

MOD -- A-Chorus (Arion SCH-1)

- Depth: 12, Rate: 0.4Hz, Tone: 45
- Always on, both states. Very light touch -- just enough shimmer to give the tone some organic width and match the slightly wobbly, unplugged-adjacent character of the recording, not an obvious chorus effect.

DLY -- Off

Not used. No delay anywhere on this part.

RVB -- Room

- Mix: 20, Decay: 35, Trail: On
- **CTL switch.** Off = bypassed, On = engaged.
- Off (verse) stays dry and close -- intimate, matching the mostly-acoustic arrangement. On (hook) adds a touch of room to open the part up slightly for the "crash into me" lift -- a small nudge, not a swell, since this song's dynamic range never gets as big as a rock chorus.

CTL Summary (GP-5)

- **CTL Off -- Verse (default load state):** Room bypassed. Dry, close, intimate -- matches the mostly-acoustic verses.
- **CTL On -- Hook ("you come crash into me"):** Room engaged. A small lift in space, not a dramatic swell -- this song stays restrained even at its biggest moment.

Full Pedalboard

Signal chain order: Flamma FS-08 Octave -> Donner Ultimate Comp -> Donner Stylish Fuzz -> Joyo Tidal Wave -> Joyo Narcissus -> Valeton GP-5.

Flamma FS-08 Octave -- bypassed

- All octave knobs (-2OCT, -OCT, +OCT, +2OCT) at 0, Dry at 100
- No octave texture anywhere in this song.

Donner Ultimate Comp -- engaged

- COMP: 38, TONE: 50, LEVEL: 55, Mode: NORMAL
- Evens out finger-attack dynamics at the source, ahead of the GP-5's own COMP -- the two stages stack lightly for a smooth, controlled melodic line without losing the part's natural dynamics entirely. NORMAL mode -- nothing to brighten, the Harmonic Booster's own voicing already has the shimmer this song wants.

Donner Stylish Fuzz -- bypassed

No fuzz texture anywhere in this song.

Joyo Tidal Wave -- engaged

- Drive: 15, Blend: 22, Presence: 48, Level: 55
- Treble: 50, Middle: 52, Bass: 55
- Mid-Frequency toggle: 500Hz (body and warmth, fits this song's woody character)
- Bass-Shift toggle: 40Hz (fuller, warmer low end -- this is a sparse acoustic arrangement, not a busy mix that needs extra tightness)
- Cab-Sim (DI out): On
- Ground Lift: Off (only flip on if a specific room throws hum)
- Drive kept very light -- this pedal is purely foundational glue and a consistent DI feed. The Harmonic Booster NAM is carrying the actual tone.

Joyo Narcissus -- bypassed

Modulation is handled by the GP-5's own MOD module (A-Chorus, light, always on). Stacking this pedal on top would fight with that.

Valeton GP-5

See GP-5 settings above.

Footswitch Choreography

- **Verse:** GP-5 CTL off. Comp and Tidal Wave running underneath, unchanged.
- **Hook ("crash into me"):** GP-5 CTL on. Step on it for the small lift, off again coming back down to the next verse.